

Jesus tells the story of the workers.

Matthew 20:1-16

Jesus told a story to explain God's generous love.

"Early one morning a farmer hired some workers to help gather his big crop of grapes. The farmer told the men how much he would pay them for a day's work. After the men had worked for a few hours, the farmer hired more workers. Those men joined the others picking grapes.

"About noon, the farmer hired even more workers! But there were so many grapes to be picked that the farmer hired more workers two more times!

"When the day was over, the farmer told his helper to gather all the workers and pay them. He told his helper to pay the workers hired last and then end with the men hired first.

"The helper paid each worker the same amount of money. The workers who had only worked for one

hour were paid the same as the men who had worked all day! The first workers complained, 'We worked all day in the hot sun for you. But you paid us the same that you paid the men who worked only an hour!'

"The farmer said that he paid each worker exactly what he had promised. The farmer was being very generous to pay all the men the same amount."

Jesus told this story so that we would know that God is like the generous farmer. No matter if we accept God's love when we're little or when we're old, God generously gives the free gift of eternal life to anyone who believes in Jesus!